

Today

- Introduction to media tourism
 - What is media tourism?
 - Main concepts
 - Ongoing projects
- Doing research in times of COVID-19
- Post-COVID-19 era and questions of cultural sustainability

Media tourism != Screentourism

Screentourists in Exeter College and the death of a fictional character:



Detective tours are famous around Europe in first and secondary cities

Initial questions

- Why would people want to visit places related to fiction?
- How do fictional narratives affect our experience of place?

Media tourism is really old:

Francesco Petrarca (1304-1374)

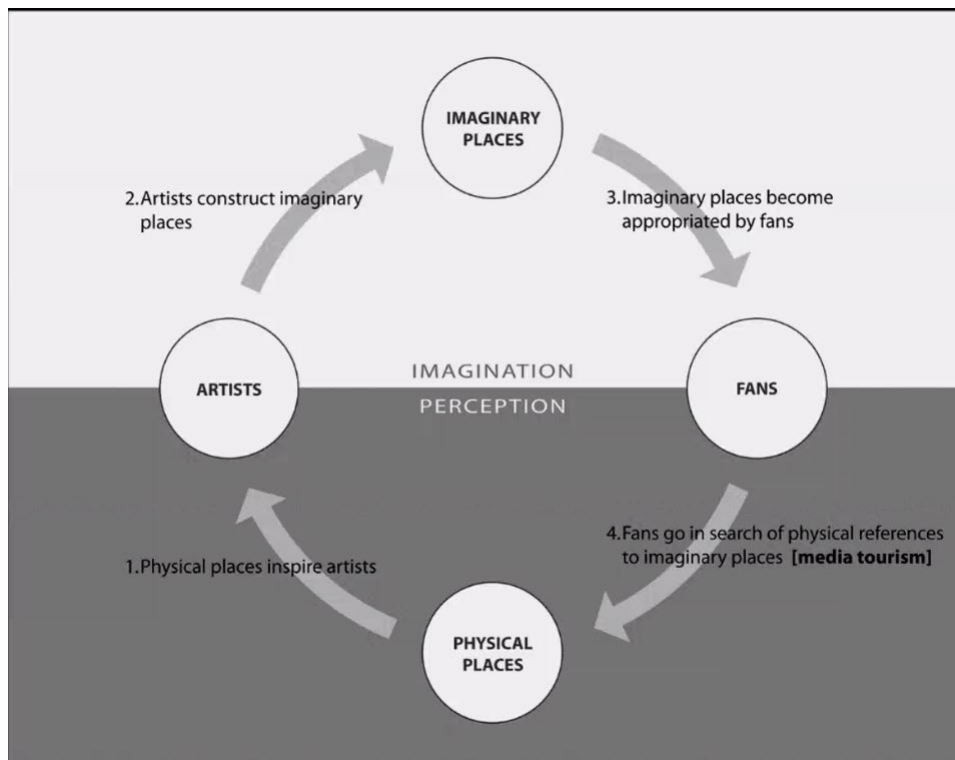


Examples:

Media tourism



Film productions are working together with local municipalities and cooperate with city marketing.



[Idee:] Levels of media related tourism

Media tourism

Screen tourism | Literature tourism | Music Tourism

Film tourism | TV tourism

On location | Off Location | Actor tourism | Studio tourism

“People have a need for places to anker their imagination, that’s why they search for these places”

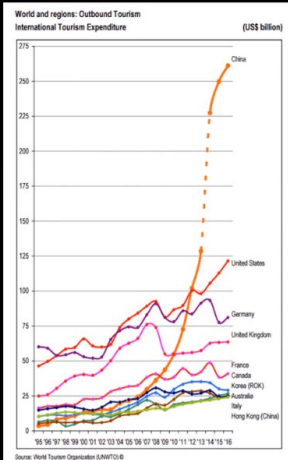
Development of research field

- Late 1990’s and 2000s: first pilot studies on film tourism
- 2010’s: fast growth of research field, contributions from various disciplines

Knowledge gaps

- Fragmented & case-based
- Little theory
- Western-centric

Globalization of tourism industry



Places of the imagination → imaginative heritage

- Questioning “places of the imagination”
 - How do they come about?
 - How do they interrelate?
 - How do they add to a more generic place identity?
- Imaginative heritage (Reijnders 2021):
generic term for the multitude of popular, fictional narratives that have been projected upon and appropriated by specific sites throughout time and that together make up an important part of local place identity.



Imaginative Narratives can become part of the heritage

Sustainable media tourism?

Environmental



Socio-economic



Cultural



Media tourism gets a lot of criticism in all 3 fields of conflict

Environmental: Star Wars Tourism on a nature refuge

Socio-Economic: Slum Dog Millionaire Slum Tours from rich tourists gazing at the poor locals

Cultural: Dracula tourism is overwriting with global popular culture the local heritage

Cultural sustainability

- Key problem: lack of agency for peripheral communities in defining their (self-) image in global popular culture
- Making media tourism an instrument for change
- Imaginative heritage as tool for policy development by local communities
 - disclosing existing imaginative heritage
 - fostering the production of future imaginative heritage, e.g. by combined film and tourism policy

“You can't have cultural power without economic power and prosperity.”

“Fictional and historical narratives are closely related. History is a narrative about the past.”

His book: <https://www.taylorfrancis.com/books/oa-edit/10.4324/9781003045359/locating-imagination-popular-culture-nicky-van-es-stijn-reijnders-leonieke-bolderman-abby-waysdorf>